

1. IDEATION PHASE

1.1 Identifying the Problem

Organizations typically receive incident reports through a variety of channels — email, telephone calls, self-service portals, and internal chat or messaging tools. When these incidents are tracked manually, several operational problems tend to surface:

- Incidents get logged late or with incomplete details.
- Category and priority values are assigned inconsistently.
- Tickets land with support groups that are not equipped to handle them.
- Investigation and resolution activities are delayed.
- Incidents that stay unresolved are not escalated in a timely manner.
- Linking related or duplicate incidents together is cumbersome.
- Existing knowledge articles are not consulted or connected to open tickets.
- Emergency changes needed to fix an incident are hard to coordinate.
- Teams have limited insight into SLA compliance.
- The same problem is solved repeatedly because earlier fixes were never documented.

These gaps point to a clear need for a **structured, automated incident-management workflow** that carries an incident all the way from intake to final closure.

1.2 Proposed Solution

To address the above issues, this project proposes building an **Incident Lifecycle Automation Solution on the ServiceNow platform**.

The solution delivers a complete, end-to-end path for incident handling: agents can log a new incident, classify it by category and priority, route it to the correct support group, monitor its progress, escalate it when needed, spin off child incidents for related issues, reference existing knowledge content, raise emergency changes where required, and ultimately resolve and close the ticket.

To achieve this, the project draws on several native ServiceNow capabilities — Incident Management, assignment groups, Knowledge Management, Change Management, related-record linking, and SLA tracking — combined into one centralized process.

1.3 Objective of the Project

This project aims to design and build an automated incident-handling workflow in ServiceNow that increases efficiency, keeps handling consistent across agents, and makes the full history of an incident traceable.

Every incident raised in the system should move through a well-defined sequence: **creation** → **classification** → **assignment** → **investigation** → **escalation or change** → **resolution** → **closure**.

1.4 Business Objectives

The project is intended to deliver the following business outcomes:

- Give Service Desk agents an efficient way to log and manage incidents.
- Strengthen classification accuracy through category, subcategory, impact, urgency, and priority fields.
- Route incidents automatically to the correct support group.
- Cut down on manual coordination effort.
- Provide a Level 2 escalation path for technically demanding incidents.
- Enable child incidents to be created and tracked against a parent record.
- Bring Knowledge Management and Incident Management closer together.
- Let emergency change requests be linked to incidents when infrastructure or application fixes are required.
- Keep SLA performance visible across the incident lifecycle.
- Preserve a full record of incident activity and related records.
- Shorten overall resolution time.
- Build a reusable knowledge base from past resolutions.
- Increase transparency and accountability across support teams.

1.5 Project Scope

The scope of this project spans the entire incident lifecycle inside ServiceNow, covering:

- Creating and configuring services/service offerings
- Logging incident records
- Classifying incidents
- Assigning and escalating incidents
- Integrating with the Knowledge Base
- Raising emergency change requests
- Creating child incidents
- Resolving incidents
- Authoring knowledge articles
- Validating SLA and related records

1.6 Expected Outcome

By the end of the project, a working incident-management workflow built on ServiceNow will be in place. It is expected to:

- Log incidents in a consistent, structured way.
- Classify each incident accurately.
- Direct incidents to the right support team.
- Provide a working escalation path to higher-tier support.
- Link incidents to relevant knowledge articles.
- Preserve parent-child relationships between related incidents.
- Tie emergency changes to the incidents that required them.
- Track incident status at every stage.

- Give visibility into SLA compliance.
- Capture solutions as knowledge for future reuse.